Policy & Standard Operating Procedure		
Title: IT Equipment and Information Disposal Policy	**Issued by:** Information Security Office	DEVSINC your technology partner

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Glossary	
GDPR	General Data Protection Regulation
HIPAA	Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act
NIST	National Institute of Standards and Technology
PCI DSS	Payment Card Industry Data Security Standards
ISO	Information Security Office

1. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish guidelines and procedures for the disposal of IT equipment and information owned by Devsinc ensuring transparency, accountability, and compliance with relevant regulations and standards such as GDPR, HIPAA, PCI-DSS, NIST 800-88 and company policies.

2. Scope:

This policy applies to all IT equipment and information owned by Devsinc that are deemed surplus, obsolete, or no longer required for company operations.

It protects the organization, its employees, clients, vendors, and any other persons who interact with them from unauthorized usage. It also helps to prevent data breaches to maintain the company's reputation.

3. Definitions:

3.1 Secure Disposal:

Secure disposal means the process and outcome by which information including information held on IT equipment is irretrievably destroyed in a manner which maintains the security of the equipment and information during the process and up to the point of irretrievable destruction.

3.2 IT Equipment:

IT equipment means all equipment purchased by or provided by Devsinc to store or process information including but not necessarily limited to desktop computers, servers, printers, copiers, laptops, tablet computers, electronic notebooks, mobile telephones, digital recorders, cameras, USB sticks, DVDs, CDs and other portable devices and removable media.

3.3 Information:

3.3.1 Information means all information and data held or recorded electronically on IT equipment or manually held or recorded on paper.

3.3.2 For the purpose of this policy, the information held by Devsinc can be divided into two categories: non-sensitive; and sensitive information. Sensitive information comprises: all personal information and all confidential information, the loss of which would, or would be likely to, cause damage or distress to individuals or to Devsinc.

3.3.3 The default category is that all information is deemed to be sensitive unless specifically identified as otherwise.

4. Responsibilities:

4.1 It is the responsibility of all Devsinc staff to ensure that the information held by the Devsinc is disposed of appropriately and that all sensitive information is disposed of securely.

4.2 All directors and managers (and designated project leaders, where applicable) are responsible for ensuring adherence to this policy within their teams. Implementation of this policy is managed through the IT Steering Committee which reports to the CEO.

5. Statement of Policy:

5.1 This policy on disposal covers all data or information held by Devsinc whether held digitally or electronically on IT equipment or as manual records held on paper or in hard copy.

5.2 It is the company's policy to ensure that all information held by Devsinc is disposed of appropriately, in conformity with the company's legal obligations and in accordance with GDPR, HIPAA, PCI-DSS and NIST 800-88 guidelines.

5.3 In particular it is the company's policy to ensure that all sensitive information which requires disposal is disposed of securely.

5.4 Where information is held on IT equipment, it is the policy of the company that such equipment will be assumed to hold sensitive information and that all information residing on such equipment must be disposed of securely.

5.5 The company supports policies which promote sustainability and take account of environmental impact. The company will therefore support recycling or sustainable redeployment in the disposal of IT equipment as long as information held on the equipment is irretrievably and securely destroyed prior to the disposal of the equipment.

6. Policy Principles:

6.1 Hard Copy:

6.1.1 Information and data held in paper or hard copy which contain sensitive information shall be irretrievably destroyed by shredding, pulping or incineration in a way in which the information cannot be reconstituted.

6.1.2 The process leading to and the process of shredding, pulping or incinerating such information shall be carried out securely.

6.2 IT Equipment:

6.2.1 Since the policy default is that all IT equipment which stores or processes data will be deemed to hold sensitive data, then all such IT equipment will undergo appropriate physical destruction or an appropriate data overwrite procedure which irretrievably destroys any data or information held on that equipment.

6.2.2 Where an overwrite procedure fails to destroy the information irretrievably, the equipment shall be physically destroyed to the extent that the information contained in it is also irretrievably destroyed.

6.2.3 For the avoidance of doubt, storage digital media including but not limited to CDs, DVDs, USB drives, hard disks where the default is that they contain sensitive data, shall, if not successfully overwritten, be physically destroyed to the extent that all data contained in the media are irretrievable.

6.2.4 All IT equipment awaiting disposal must be stored and handled securely.

6.2.5 In any case where IT equipment is to be passed on by Devsinc for re-use, those staff involved in the sale or transfer of the equipment shall ensure that any information on the equipment has been irretrievably destroyed and that any other appropriate issues, including, but not limited to, the safety of the equipment are satisfactorily addressed.

6.3 Online Data:

6.3.1 Data held in the Devsinc's authorized online storage applications should be destroyed to the extent possible by using the delete facilities provided.

7. Guidelines for Staff:

7.1 Hard Copy:

7.1.1 Staff holding Devsinc data in hard copy should routinely dispose of the data when it is no longer required to be held for legal or contractual purposes or is no longer necessary for the business purpose for which it was originally created or held. In determining whether and when the data should be disposed of, staff should consult the senior management.

7.1.2 It is good practice to shred, pulp or incinerate all company data which requires destruction. Where hard copy waste is sensitive data (as defined in 3.3.2) it should always be securely and irretrievably destroyed by shredding, pulping or incineration. In order to ensure the secure and irretrievable destruction of hard copy, staff are required to use the service provided by the company for the destruction of confidential waste.

7.1.3 Where staff consider a document is of sufficient historic importance to be retained by the company, they should consult the senior management.

7.2 IT Equipment:

7.2.1 Staff holding Devsinc data on IT equipment should routinely dispose of the data when it is no longer required to be held for legal or contractual purposes or is no longer necessary for the business purpose for which it was originally created or held. In determining whether and when the data should be disposed of, staff should consult the company's senior management.

7.2.2 Staff should also be mindful that IT equipment provided by Devsinc shall be returned to the IT department for the secure return and disposal of the information or equipment.

7.3 Online Data:

7.3.1 Staff using the delete facility provided by the company's online applications should be aware that the deleted material will be held for 30 days in their online "bin". Such data will not be regarded as "beyond use" until it has been further deleted from the "bin".

7.3.2 Online data held in accounts provided to staff by the company for the purpose of their employment is not automatically deleted when staff leave the company. These accounts are deactivated and access to the data retained for any necessary business purpose. Prior to leaving the company, staff should, wherever possible, ensure the appropriate management and handover of the company data in their accounts, deleting from their accounts data which are no longer required by the company.

Note: *Please contact the IT department to ensure the best procedure for the destruction of personal data within digital files, records or databases, including cloud-stored data as each record type may require a different process and each cloud provider may have different protocols for the secure deletion of data.*

8. Record and Reporting:

8.1 Maintain a record of information and IT equipment disposal and it must be submitted to the respective director.

8.2 All staff and other users of information should report immediately to the IT department or Information Security Office (ISO) using the contact details below if they observed or suspected incidents where sensitive information has or may have been insecurely disposed of.

- Slack: it_helpdesk
- MapleHR: IT department
- Extension Number: 1009 (IT department)
- Email ID: information.security@devsinc.com

9. Enforcement and Monitoring:

This process is enforced for all employees of Devsinc and monitored by senior management. Any employee who is found to have breached this policy may be subject to disciplinary action up to and including termination.

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